

WOW!

In 2010, in one of the world's biggest traffic jams, thousands of cars were stuck on a Chinese highway for more than 10 days.



Transparent blocks placed on top of solar panels

ENERGY-GENERATING ROADS

Road engineers are now experimenting with the idea that roads could produce energy. In the future, roads may not just be a flat tarmac surface, they could be built with solar panels, or piezoelectric panels, which use the pressure of vehicles passing over them to generate an electric current.

THE OPEN ROAD

Highways, freeways, and expressways are wide roads for motor vehicles to travel fast. These have separate lanes to allow safe overtaking, with no signals and road junctions, allowing a continual flow of traffic. Opened in 1908, the Long Island Motor Parkway was the first motorway in the US. Italy opened its first motorway in 1921, but it was in Germany in the 1930s that the idea really took off.

▼ AUTOBAHN, 1935

Multilane highways in Germany are called autobahns. These were first planned in the 1920s, but were not completed until 1935.

